

87.2 FOCUSING WITH "WHAT" CLAUSES

Simple statements can be made more emphatic by adding "what" with the verb "be." This structure is often used with verbs expressing emotions, such as "love," "hate," "like," and "want."

Would you like to go to a movie?



No, thanks. **What** I really want **is** to go to bed early.

"What" is added to the start of the sentence.

The focused information is put outside the "what" clause.

This has more emphasis than "I really want to go to bed early."

FURTHER EXAMPLES

What we hated **was** the bad service.

What I like here **is** the weather.

What they loved the most **were** the museums.

What she enjoys the most **is** the music.

87.3 FOCUSING WITH A NOUN

If the subject of the sentence cannot be replaced with "what" (for example, people, places, or times) a general noun that has a similar meaning can be used.



I've been to many countries.

The place I most enjoyed visiting **was** Nepal.



I've read about some great people.

The woman I respect the most **is** Marie Curie.



I don't know why the show was canceled.

The reason they gave **was** not good enough.



I have lots of fun memories.

The evening I remember most **is** my first concert.